DumbPhone Lock — Launch Playbook

> *Complete step-by-step guide to validate market demand using the Hormozi framework. Goal: 100+ waitlist signups in 48 hours = GO on $99 Apple Developer account.*

Phase 1: Pre-Launch Checklist (Before Posting)

- [ ] Landing page live at marceausolutions.com/dumbphone
- [ ] Link-in-bio page live at marceausolutions.com/links
- [ ] n8n workflows active (3): Waitlist Capture, Email Confirm, SMS Drip
- [ ] Google Sheets tab "DumbPhone Waitlist" exists with headers
- [ ] Test signup works end-to-end (form → sheet → email → SMS)
- [ ] Bio links updated on all social platforms to marceausolutions.com/links

---

Phase 2: Organic Launch (Day 1 — Free)

Reddit Thread Hunting (Do First — 30 min)

Before posting your own threads, find and comment on existing conversations. This looks organic and builds credibility.

Subreddits to Search:

Subreddit	Size	Search Keywords
r/nosurf	~400K	"screen time", "block apps", "dumb phone"
r/digitalminimalism	~250K	"light phone", "phone addiction", "app blocker"
r/productivity	~2.5M	"focus app", "phone distraction", "deep work"
r/dumbphones	~50K	"iPhone", "want dumb phone but", "best app"
r/getdisciplined	~1M	"phone addiction", "can't stop scrolling"

r/selfimprovement	~1.5M	"screen time", "digital detox"

How to Find Threads:

1. Go to each subreddit
2. Use the search bar with the keywords above
3. Sort by "New" or "Hot"
4. Look for threads where people are asking for solutions

Comment Templates:

For "what app should I use" threads:

> *I've been working on something for this exact problem. Most apps just send you a notification you can dismiss. I'm building one that uses Apple's FamilyControls API — the same system parents use to lock their kids' phones. You literally can't access blocked apps. Still in early development but I have a waitlist if you want to try it: marceausolutions.com/dumbphone*

For "I want a dumb phone but need X" threads:

> *This is exactly why I started building DumbPhone Lock. I didn't want to spend $300 on a Light Phone and lose maps/banking. So I'm making an app that turns your iPhone into a dumb phone on demand — keep the apps you need, block everything else. Waitlist here if you're interested: marceausolutions.com/dumbphone*

For "screen time limits don't work" threads:

> *Screen Time limits fail because you can dismiss them in one tap. I'm building an app that uses Apple's FamilyControls API — the same blocking tech parents use for kids' phones. You literally can't bypass it. Still early stage: marceausolutions.com/dumbphone*

Reddit Posts (30 min apart, after commenting)

Post dedicated threads in this order:

Order	Subreddit	Post	UTM

1	r/nosurf	"I built an app that turns your iPhone into a dumb phone..."	`?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campai`
2	r/productivity	"It takes 23 minutes to refocus after a distraction..."	`?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campai`
3	r/ digitalminimalism	"Instead of buying a dumb phone, I'm building an app..."	`? utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campaig`
4	r/dumbphones	"I want a dumb phone but need maps, banking, and Uber..."	`?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campai`

Full copy for each post: see `dumbphone-launch-copy.md`

Twitter/X Thread

Post the 9-tweet thread from `dumbphone-launch-copy.md`. Key tips:

- Post all 9 tweets as a thread (not individually)
- Pin the thread to your profile
- Reply to your own thread 1-2 hours later with a screenshot of the app

Instagram Reel

- Upload your screen recording of the app in action
- Use the caption from `dumbphone-launch-copy.md`
- Add all 10 hashtags
- Add "Link in bio" as the CTA

TikTok Video

- Upload same screen recording (vertical 9:16)
- Keep under 30 seconds
- Text overlay: "Turn your iPhone into a dumb phone"
- Caption from `dumbphone-launch-copy.md`

Hacker News — Show HN

- Post the technical version from `dumbphone-launch-copy.md`
- Best posting times: 6-9am EST weekdays
- Respond to every comment within the first 2 hours

Phase 3: Paid Ads (Day 1-5 — $100 Total)

Meta Ads — $50 (Facebook + Instagram)

Setup: business.facebook.com > Ads Manager > New Campaign

Setting	Value
Objective	Leads (or Traffic if no pixel)
Budget	$5-10/day for 5 days
Placement	IG Feed, IG Stories, IG Reels, FB Feed
Schedule	Start today, run 5 days

Ad Set 1: "Digital Minimalism"

- Age: 18-44, US
- Interests: Digital minimalism, Cal Newport, Deep Work, Productivity, Focus

Ad Set 2: "Phone Addiction"

- Age: 18-34, US
- Interests: Screen time, Digital detox, Dopamine detox, Mindfulness, Self-improvement

3 Creative Variants: Problem Hook (video), Comparison Hook (video), Stat Hook (static image) Full specs in `dumbphone-ad-briefs.md`

TikTok Ads — $25

Setup: ads.tiktok.com > New Campaign

Setting	Value
Objective	Traffic
Budget	$5-10/day for 5 days
Placement	TikTok Feed
Age	18-34, US
Interests	Self improvement, Productivity, Technology

Reddit Ads — $25

Setup: ads.reddit.com > New Campaign

Setting	Value
Objective	Traffic
Budget	$5/day for 5 days
Subreddit targeting	r/nosurf, r/productivity, r/digitalminimalism, r/getdisciplined, r/selfimprovement, r/dumbphones, r/minimalism

---

Phase 4: Competitor Positioning

Use these angles when people mention competitors:

Competitor	Price	Their Weakness	Your Angle
Opal	$79.99/yr	Too expensive	"Free/cheap, same result"
One Sec	$4.99/mo	Just pauses, doesn't block	"Real lock, not a nudge"

AppBlock	Free-$5/mo	Android-first, iOS limited	"Built native for iOS"
Forest	Free-$4	Gamification, no real block	"Uses Apple's actual blocking API"
Freedom	$8.99/mo	No FamilyControls lock	"Can't bypass — same tech as parental controls"
ScreenZen	Free	No enforcement	"Real enforcement, not suggestions"
Light Phone	$299 + plan	Separate device, no maps/banking	"Uses your existing iPhone, keeps essential apps"

Key differentiator: Apple's FamilyControls API = same system parents use to lock kids' phones. You can't dismiss it with one tap like Screen Time limits.

Phase 5: Monitoring & Metrics

Check Every 12 Hours

- [ ] Google Sheets "DumbPhone Waitlist" — count new signups
- [ ] UTM breakdown — which source is converting best
- [ ] n8n execution logs — any failed workflows
- [ ] Reddit post engagement — upvotes, comments, saves
- [ ] Ad dashboards — CPC, CTR, cost per lead

Ad Kill Criteria

Metric	Kill If	After
CPC (Cost per Click)	> $1.00	48 hours
CTR (Click-Through Rate)	< 0.5%	48 hours
Cost per Lead	> $5.00	48 hours

Good Metrics

Metric	Good	Great

Landing page	marceausolutions.com/dumbphone
Link-in-bio	marceausolutions.com/links
Ready-to-paste copy	`marketing/dumbphone-launch-copy.md`
Ad specs & briefs	`marketing/dumbphone-ad-briefs.md`
Google Sheet	"Challenge Leads" > "DumbPhone Waitlist" tab
n8n Waitlist Capture	Workflow ID: A9TdMLSIjUBXYXiI
n8n Email Confirm	Workflow ID: ilNn24FqfZcYGxcT
n8n SMS Drip	Workflow ID: 4GKRU7i0JOh01yVT

Marceau Solutions — Embrace the Pain & Defy the Odds